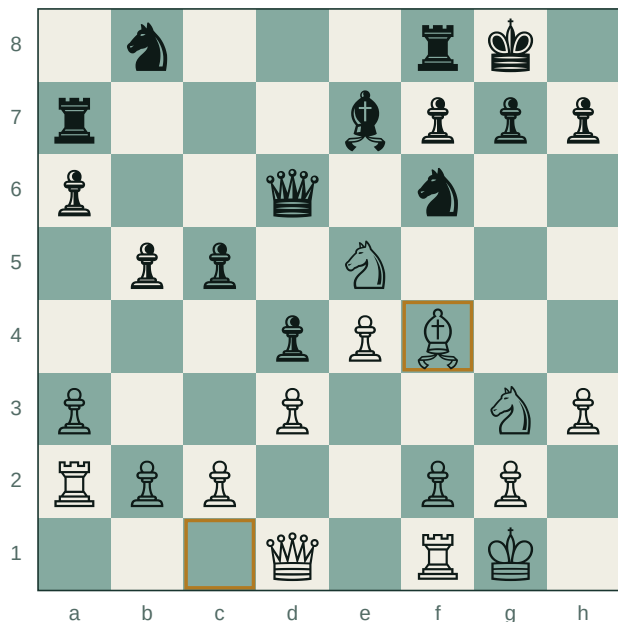


Clearance tactics: Black, move 15

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 15.Bf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Qe6 16. b3 Bd6

15...Qe6 The queen moves from d6 to e6. From e6 it attacks rook on a2 and knight on e5. Recorded reply: **16.b3**.

16...Bd6 The bishop moves from e7 to d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 36 / Black 35 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on f4 and rook on a2. Check for tactical protection.